



Genetics dictates that only cats and human males are funny; females only need to giggle on command

ovulating. We think this is because wit and humour signify a mating ritual that's usually played out in the animal kingdom. Although there are exceptions to every rule, in general, the animal kingdom consists of males vying for the favours of females. In mammals, because females have to carry the pregnancy, this courtship is especially pronounced. Thus, males use more than looks (they also use humour and wit) to show that they have good genes. Studies have shown that although men and women can be as funny as one another, and one of the most common desired traits on dating sites is "Sense of humour", it applies very differently to the sexes. What women generally mean when they list that desire is that they want a man who can make them laugh, while men usually mean that they want a woman who will laugh at their jokes or silliness. According to the data collected, it's suggested that men don't necessarily want a woman who's funny, or wittier than them.

Whatever the case, geneticists and psychologists seem to believe that there is a clear evolutionary advantage to having the humour gene express itself prominently

in your DNA. The same applies to satire, slapstick comedy, and even trolling.

FEED THE TROLLS, THEY HAVE A PURPOSE

Since almost all trolls derive pleasure from trolling, we can conclude that they're essentially indulging in the animal behaviour of playing. The reason they persist is because we, the non-trolls, find it funny (at least in some instances), which encourages them to continue.

However, there certainly is another much more important case to be made for trolling. Yes perhaps such behaviour is in-built into many of us, and yes, perhaps there is a troll-gene that's actually beneficial for evolution... however, we think there are a few important aspects in which trolls (some, not all) play a vital role in society.

To start with, the trolls are usually always pushing on our limits of tolerance. It takes a person to blow up a few times and be affected by trolls before he or she starts developing thicker skin. One of the side effects of developing thicker skin is the willingness to listen to more

contrarian views without losing your cool. Thus, the journey that a troll starts you on with regards to some random discussion on the internet, could actually culminate in you being a more tolerant person – not just online either.

The anonymity of a lot of trolls are also the reason they're able to speak their mind openly, and often rudely. Now, of course, sometimes the troll attempts to sidetrack the conversation, or starts inserting fallacies, however, there are a few times when a troll will make a valid point, and speak out and say what many others may be thinking but be too polite to say out loud (type out loud?). This is obviously because their real identity is not at risk of being exposed.

Trolls are especially useful for pushing boundaries in any discussion regarding religion, or some other similar topic that usually offends people very quickly – nationalism is one hot example in India these days.

Even if you believe in none of the above reasons, you will have to admit that (when you're not the target) trolling can be a heck of a lot of fun. Why? Because no matter how civilised we think we are, we



People are often told not to feed the trolls (don't encourage them by replying)

love it when two of our own species decide it's time to have a good roll in the mud, hurting themselves. There's a reason why the Romans were able to entertain both men and women with the gladiator games – we humans are sick, and deep down, we really, really want to feed the trolls! 